



The Hour of His Judgment

Part 2

Sabbath School Study Notes

Lesson 4

PHASE 4 SDA BRANCH

Revelation 14:7

THE FIRST ANGEL'S MESSAGE • LESSON 4 • PART 2 • REVELATION 14:7

The Hour of His Judgment

Revelation 14:7

R Recap

We spoke about judgment last week and defined it as an act that has an outcome. Judgment can be understood as:

1	Decision-making
2	Opinion
3	Legal system

What we primarily examined was judgment as a legal system — where different opinions are presented before a judge and a decision is made.

1 The Problem With Human Justice

Matthew 27:11–23 | Genesis 39:1–21

In a perfect world, fair judgment would always be carried out. But that is not our reality. People are falsely accused and imprisoned every day.

Jesus was falsely accused of a crime He did not commit (Matthew 27:11–23). Joseph was falsely accused of a crime he did not commit (Genesis 39:1–21). In some form, many of us have been falsely accused of things we never did — and people believed it.

On the other side, there are sins that were committed by people who were never caught. Still in Matthew 27, Barabbas — a thief — was released, while Jesus was condemned. How, then, can we trust in fair judgment in this world, given how lopsided things are?

2 The Standard of Perfect Justice

Proverbs 16:11

What are weights and scales used for? To measure and ensure that things are equal. Proverbs 16:11 tells us that honest weights and scales belong to the Lord — God's standard of measurement is perfect and impartial.

Even human civilisation has recognised the need for impartial judgment — the Roman goddess Justitia, often placed outside courthouses, represents this ideal. It is worth noting that Justitia was not a real god — she was a man-made concept, a symbol created to represent the ideal of fairness and impartiality. This mirrors what Solomon says in Proverbs 16:11.

If we are in pursuit of fair judgment, we must look to a fair God. From the case of Adam and Eve we saw this clearly: God is fair and just.

3 The Prosperity of the Wicked: Asaph's Dilemma

Psalms 73:1–17

In Psalm 73, Asaph observed how the wicked prosper and how life seems to go well for them, while for the children of God the opposite often appears to be true. But then Asaph says something important:

"When I thought how to understand this, it was too painful for me — until I went into the sanctuary of God; then I understood their end."

— Psalms 73:16–17 (NKJV)

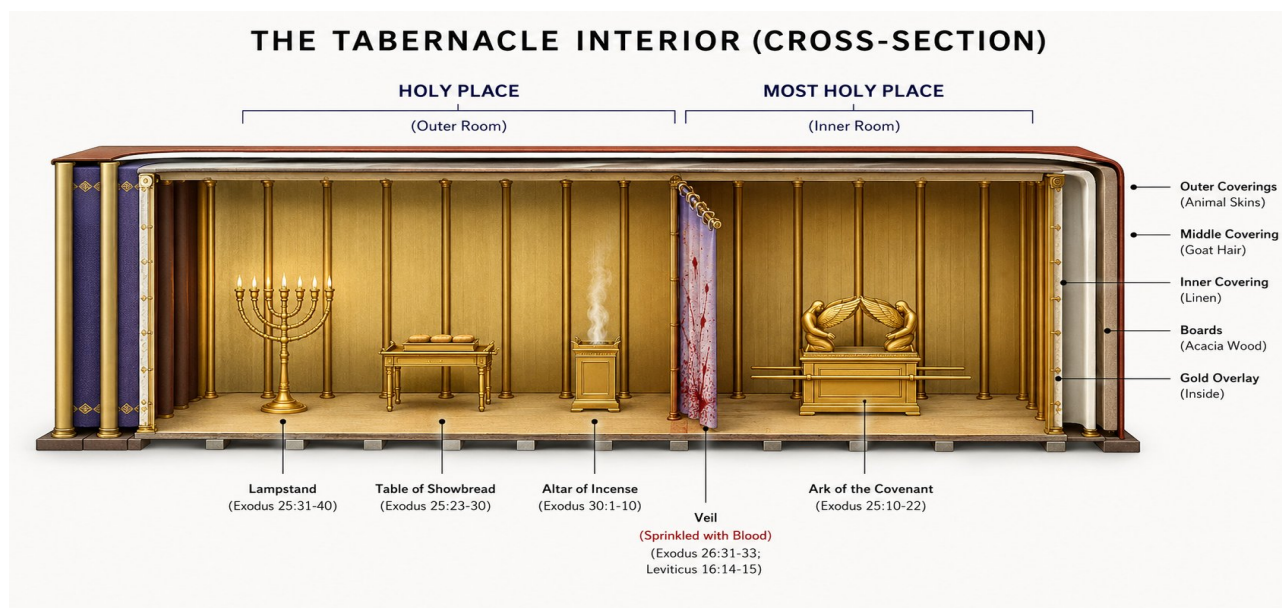
The sanctuary plays a key role in vindicating the cause of the children of God. We need to understand how.

4 The Sanctuary System

The sanctuary was introduced to the children of Israel to establish a system of worship that was distinct — especially after their 400 years in captivity. Within this system, there are three key roles:

1	Sinner	The person who has committed the sin
2	Sacrifice	The animal slain on behalf of the sinner
3	Advocate	The priest — the one responsible for officiating the service

The priest would enter the tabernacle in the absence of the sinner, carrying the blood of the sacrifice slain on the sinner's behalf.



Overview of the Israelite Tabernacle — The Court, The Laver, the Altar of Sacrifice, and the Tabernacle itself.

Leviticus 4:1–29

Leviticus 4 shows us that sin touches every level of society:

Category	Reference
The Priest	Leviticus 4:1–7
The Congregation	Leviticus 4:11–17
The Ruler	Leviticus 4:22–25
The Common People	Leviticus 4:27–29

Romans 3:23 | Isaiah 59:1–2

Romans 3:23 tells us why every category is included: all have sinned and fallen short of the glory of God. Sin causes separation between people and God — yet it is God who comes in search of us (Isaiah 59:1–2). The sacrificial system was an acknowledgment of the sinner's guilt, with the blood on the veil serving as evidence that sin had been committed and confessed.

However, the sanctuary would be meaningless if people merely acknowledged their sins and slaughtered animals out of routine. There is a greater lesson at work here.

5 The Purpose of the Sacrifice

Hebrews 9:24 | Leviticus 17:11

Hebrews 9:24 and Leviticus 17:11 show that the slaying of the animal brought atonement between the sinner and God. Through the sacrifice, the sinner acknowledges that it is only through a mediator that they can be brought back into right standing with God.

But here is a question: does killing an animal automatically bring forgiveness? To bring it closer to home — do we receive forgiveness simply because we pray?

Matthew 15:8 | Psalms 51:16–18 | Psalms 51:3–4 (NKJV)

"For I acknowledge my transgressions, and my sin is always before me. Against You, You only, have I sinned, and done this evil in Your sight — that You may be found just when You speak, and blameless when You judge."

— Psalms 51:3–4 (NKJV)

Matthew 15:8 addresses prayer that is not rooted in the heart. Psalms 51:16–18 shows that God delights in a broken spirit. Our hearts should be broken because of the things that separate us from God — not merely going through the motions.

**KEY
INSIGHT**

Sacrificing in vain — Isaiah 1:11–15. Praying in vain — Matthew 6:5–8. The outward act without an inward heart is meaningless to God.

6 Why Judgment?

Leviticus 10:10 | Ecclesiastes 12:14 | Ecclesiastes 11:9

Here is the challenge: Leviticus 10:10 establishes that a distinction must be made between the holy and the common, the righteous and the wicked. How will God effectively make that distinction?

Ecclesiastes 12:14 and 11:9 answer the question: God will bring every deed into judgment — including every hidden thing, whether good or evil. This is why judgment.

7 Our Framework

To guide our study of the judgment, we are using the following framework:

WHO	God
WHAT	Judgment — a decision-making, opinion-based legal system
WHY	To bring every deed into judgment and reveal whether it is good or bad
WHERE	To be addressed in the next lesson
HOW	To be addressed in the next lesson

We have answered Who, What, and Why. The next important questions are How and Where. To answer them, we need to look carefully at the Old Testament sanctuary system.

**NEXT
WEEK**

Assignment: How will God judge? Study the Old Testament sanctuary system and come prepared to discuss how judgment was carried out within it.